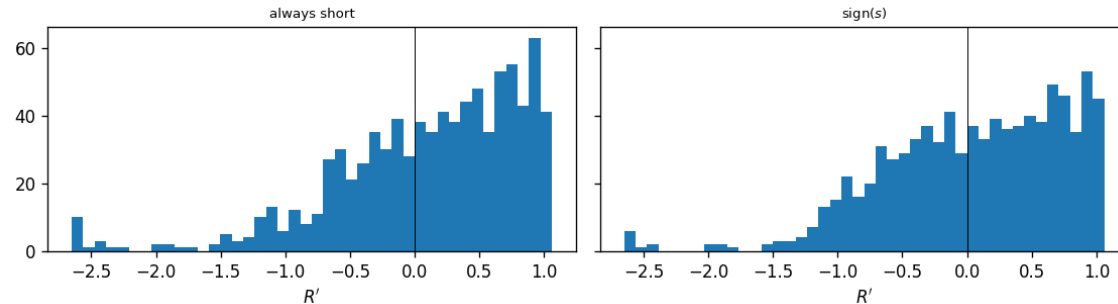


0DTE nearest-OTM straddle: per-rule return summary, entry 15:00 ET, held to cash-settle, models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe _{clk}	n_{buy}	%buy	Sharpe _{clk} ^x
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>												
all models (no forecast)	866	0.095	0.778	-5.81	1.04	-1.95	7.83	3.59	1.93	0	0.0	1.40
sign(s) (± 1 on the sign of s)												
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	866	0.030	0.783	-5.81	3.95	-1.25	6.88	1.12	0.60	201	23.2	0.07
block-diagonal ridge	866	0.065	0.781	-5.81	3.95	-0.97	7.10	2.47	1.33	186	21.5	0.80
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	866	0.068	0.781	-5.81	3.95	-0.97	7.11	2.55	1.37	189	21.8	0.84
LightGBM [†]	866	0.053	0.782	-5.81	3.95	-0.94	7.00	2.01	1.08	205	23.7	0.55
XGBoost [†]	866	0.043	0.783	-5.81	3.95	-0.94	6.92	1.60	0.86	220	25.4	0.33
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.064	0.781	-5.81	3.95	-1.01	7.09	2.40	1.29	198	22.9	0.76
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	866	0.071	0.781	-5.81	3.95	-0.99	7.15	2.67	1.44	185	21.4	0.90
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	866	0.047	0.782	-5.81	3.95	-1.12	7.00	1.78	0.96	190	21.9	0.43

block-diagonal ridge, midpoint fills: entry 15:00 ET, held to cash-settle; return of the position, 1st-99th percentile window (bars: the days with $R' \neq 0$)



Distribution of the return of the position taken at 15:00 ET, block-diagonal ridge forecast, one panel per rule (returns inside their 1st–99th percentile window).

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM straddle at 15:00 ET, hold those strikes to the official close, and delta-hedge every 30 minutes. 866 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck’s frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and cash-settle at the official close (no exit spread). One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction. “ex. kurt” is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. **Two Sharpes.** Both multiply by $\sqrt{252}$ because an expiration day is the unit of time (same year-length as the paper). They are not the same object. On a *single-clock* page, Sharpe_{clk} = (mean/std) $\times \sqrt{252}$ of that clock’s series: one remaining-session short per expiration day (enter at this clock, hold those strikes to the close, delta-hedge every 30 minutes). It answers “if I only entered at this clock, what is my annual Sharpe?” It is *not* the book’s Sharpe_{ann}. On the *pooled* page, Sharpe_{ann} = (mean/std) $\times \sqrt{252}$ of $R_d^{\text{day}} = \sum_t R'_{d,t}$, the sum of the day’s twelve overlapping remaining-session books. That reserved name is the book’s daily P&L after pooling the session. The twelve books overlap; they are not twelve successive 30-minute holds. Sharpe^x is the same convention at the crossed spread. Every other column is daily. n_{buy} is the number of expiration days with position > 0 (always-short is 0; on the pooled page it is days the sum of the twelve positions is positive); %buy is $100 \cdot n_{\text{buy}}/n$, the notebook’s column. The other column this table adds to the deck’s is Sharpe_{ann}^x, the same rule’s annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck’s.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). [†] marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - IV_{\text{hr}}^2 h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. w_t is the expanding mean of each prior day’s remaining-session share of realized variance, $RV_t / \sum_{s \geq t} RV_s$ (in-fit panel history back to 2001), not the ratio of trailing clock-means. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck’s treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.